



Pentecost International Christian Centre

Prison Ministry Manual

Purpose and Vision

- **Mission:**

To fulfill PICC's mission of bringing hope to the hopeless, life to the dying, and helping them become true disciples of Jesus Christ through sharing the gospel of Jesus Christ with incarcerated people, restoring lives through discipleship, and supporting successful re-entry so they flourish as followers of Jesus Christ. Matthew 25:36

- **Core values:**

1. **Christ-Centeredness**

We uphold Jesus Christ as the foundation of all we do. John 14:6

2. **Compassion**

We serve inmates with love, dignity, and without judgement - Mathew 25:36

3. **Transformation**

We believe in total life change through the power of the Gospel – 2 Corinthians 5:17

4. **Integrity**

We maintain honesty, accountability, and ethical conduct in ministry –
Proverbs 10:9

5. **Discipleship**

We are committed to nurturing spiritual growth and maturity – Matthew 28:19-20.

6. **Restoration**

We promote healing, forgiveness, and reintegration into society. – Galatians 6:1

- **Motto**

From Prison to Purpose in Christ!

Theological Foundation

- **Gospel focus:** Salvation by grace through faith in Christ (**Eph. 2:8–10**). Present both the love and holiness of God.
- **Discipleship model:** Follow Jesus' call to repentance, obedience, community, and mission (**Luke 9:23; Matthew 28:18–20**).
- **Pastoral ethics:** Honor inmate dignity as image-bearers, maintain truth and hope, practice restorative—not punitive—care where possible.

Program Structure — Overview

- **Intake & Orientation**
 - Obtain necessary permissions with prison administration.
 - Orientation for new participants: program purpose, schedule, expectations, confidentiality, grievance process.
 - Basic assessment (spiritual, educational, mental health, re-entry needs).
- **Regular Ministry Components**
 - Worship/Service: Weekly gatherings including scripture, testimony, prayer, and accessible sermon/application.
 - One-to-One Mentoring: Matched mentors for invested relationships, practical discipleship, and re-entry planning.
 - Pastoral Care & Counseling: Crisis visits, grief support, conflict mediation, spiritual direction; referral to Senior Pastors when needed.
 - Practical Life-Skills & Re-entry Training: Resume-building, financial literacy, parenting, anger management, job-readiness, housing referrals.
 - Vocational/Service Opportunities: Bible teaching assistants, worship teams, restorative projects, peer counseling roles.
 - Family & Visitation Support: Family services, visitation help, restorative family reconciliation when appropriate.
 - Follow-up After Release: Community church connections, mentoring continuation, employment & housing referrals.

Prison Ministry Members/Volunteers

- Desired qualities: Be a member of PICC, preferably a HOSOM graduate, with humility, cultural sensitivity, commitment to confidentiality and safe boundaries, commitment to long-term involvement.
- Training: Orientation to prison rules, de-escalation, trauma-informed care, cultural competency, safe physical contact policies, confidentiality, mandatory reporting, and program curriculum.
- Ongoing Support: Regular debriefings, spiritual retreats, supervision, and performance review.

Training Essentials

- Basic theology of grace and repentance.
- Cultural awareness of incarceration culture and trauma.
- Communication skills: active listening, motivational interviewing basics.
- Crisis management: recognizing suicidality, mental illness signs, procedures for emergencies.
- Boundaries and ethics: no promises beyond scope, no favoritism, physical contact rules.
- Practical procedures: sign-in/out, contraband awareness, movement within facility, documentation requirements.

Curriculum & Materials

- Evangelism: Gospel presentation outline, testimony guidelines, tract or booklet for inmates.
- Discipleship curricula (progressive, reproducible):
 - New Believers: Basics of Christian faith, prayer, reading the Bible, baptism, joining a community.
 - Foundations: Spiritual disciplines, doctrine basics, identity in Christ, anger and forgiveness.
 - Growth: Theology, apologetics for faith under pressure, servant leadership, finances and stewardship.
 - Leadership Training: How to lead small groups, teach Scripture, run worship, serve peers.
- Recommended resources: Books authored by Senior Pastor Esau Banda, Other discipleship guides, Christian living books appropriate for prison (obtainable and approved by both PICC and the Prison authorities).

Meeting Formats & Sample Agendas

- Opening prayers
- Praise and Worship
- Testimonies
- Worship, followed by teaching
- Praying and Declarations
- Alter Call for Salvation and prayer as led by the Holy Spirit
- Announcements and Offerings
- Declaration of Psalm 23:6
- One on One mentoring where needed.

Counseling, Crisis Response & Mental Health

- Establish referral network with prison mental health staff and external licensed counselors.
- Use trauma-informed approaches; avoid re-traumatizing questions or events.
- Suicide/self-harm protocol: Know facility's emergency procedures; do not promise confidentiality if safety is at risk.
- Grief and addiction support groups: Offer curriculum and referral to professional treatment when required.

Safety, Legal & Ethical Considerations

- Follow all facility rules, dress codes, contraband policies.
- Mandatory reporting and confidentiality: Know state/facility laws about reporting abuse, threats, or pending crimes.
- Boundaries: No visits to cells alone unless policy allows and records exist; avoid one-on-one physical contact prohibited by facility.
- Scripture & doctrine: Avoid political or radical theological positions; focus on core gospel and allowed books.

Partnerships & Community Integration

- Work with chaplaincy and correctional staff; cultivate regular communication and reporting.
- Build relationships with employment agencies, social services, housing programs, and legal aid.
- Develop a re-entry coalition: regular meetings to coordinate housing, jobs, ID replacement, transportation, and counseling post-release.

Measuring Impact & Program Evaluation

- Track inputs and outcomes: attendance, baptisms, number of mentors, classes delivered, recidivism rate (long-term).
- Use qualitative measures: testimonies, case studies, participant goals achieved.
- Regular reviews: Quarterly program reports; annual strategic review with stakeholders.

Sustainability & Funding

- Funding sources: Church support, individual donors, grants, in-kind donations.
- Budget priorities: Training, materials, transportation, staff/coordination, background checks, communication.
- Volunteer retention: Ongoing training, appreciation, pastoral care for volunteers, clear expectations.

Sample Forms & Templates (summaries)

- Volunteer application and reference check form
- Volunteer covenant & confidentiality agreement
- Participant intake form (spiritual background, needs assessment, consent for ministry)
- Incident report template
- Mentor-mentee agreement and progress log (Prepare printable versions tailored to facility requirements.)

Practical Tips for Ministry Inside Prisons

- Be consistent: Show up regularly; reliability builds trust.
- Listen first: Many inmates need to be heard before any teaching penetrates.
- Keep teaching practical and applicable to daily life.
- Encourage ownership: Train inmates to lead and disciple peers.
- Respect culture: Learn prison norms and language; avoid judgmental tones.
- Be patient: Transformation often slow; celebrate small steps.
- Pray—consistently and corporately—for inmates, staff, and ministry fruit.

Sample Week-by-Week 12-Week Discipleship Outline

1. Foundations: Who is God? Who am I?
2. Gospel: Repentance and Faith
3. Prayer & Scripture: How to connect with God

4. Identity in Christ and overcoming shame
5. Forgiveness and reconciliation
6. Broken relationships & peacemaking
7. Habit & holiness: practical spiritual disciplines
8. Anger, impulse control, and restitution
9. Work, stewardship, and responsibility
10. Family, healthy masculinity/femininity, parenting
11. Apologetics & living faith in adversity
12. Commissioning, next steps, church connection

Discipleship to Re-entry Pathway

- Early prison: spiritual assessment, foundational teaching, crisis care.
- Mid-term: deeper Bible study, vocational training, mentor assignment.
- Pre-release (90–180 days): re-entry plan—ID, housing, job, church placement, ongoing mentor.
- Post-release: connection with local church, mentor check-ins, job/education support, relapse prevention.

Volunteer Covenant (key points)

- Represent Christ well, honor facility rules, maintain confidentiality (with limits for safety), commit to training and regular attendance, report concerns promptly, work under ministry leadership (abide with PICC core values and Prison Ministry Core Values).

Common Challenges & Solutions

- Challenge: Volunteer burnout — Solution: rotation, supervision, realistic expectations, spiritual care.
- Challenge: Resistance from facility — Solution: build relationships, document outcomes, stay compliant.
- Challenge: Relapse/recidivism — Solution: strengthen re-entry supports, realistic planning, community accountability.
- Challenge: Cultural barriers — Solution: cultural competency training, hire mentors with lived experience when possible.

Suggested Resources

- Accessible Bible translations (Use any other versions, NKJV is PICC's default version)
- Discipleship curricula: Conduct membership classes, Discipleship classes and HOSOM classes.
- Books: Books authored by Senior Pastor Esau Banda, and other Prison Christian Books.
- Contact list: chaplain, mental health services, re-entry agencies, legal aid
- Sample prayers, testimony template, and brief gospel presentation

Steps to Launching a Branch in New Prisons

1. Secure permission and understand facility requirements.
2. Connect with possible volunteers from a PICC branch near the new Prison
3. Orient the new team and keep following them up to monitor progress and establishment
4. Build partnership with chaplain at the new Prison.

Conclusion

PICC Prison Ministry is NOT independent, it is an arm of PICC as a church. In this regard, the ministry must never leave the path of PICC's mandate, values and beliefs.